

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS



INDIA-RUSSIA -1

MODULE - 36

INDO-RUSSIA RELATIONS

- 1 India-Russia relations date back to the Soviet era and started their relations after India's independence.
- 2 Soviet Union and India's relations has been the most successful relation that Russia has had with a Third World country. PM Nehru immensely in Soviet Union's Development model which emphasized upon social justice, equality and human dignity.
- 3 India and present Russia are based on similar civilizational values, time-tested friendship, mutual understanding, trust, common interests and proximity of approaches to the fundamental issues of development and economic progress.



INDO-RUSSIA RELATIONS

A discussion of the relationship can be divided into

- Cold War period
- Post Cold War period
- Contemporary relationship



COLD WAR PERIOD (1945-1989)

- 1** The relationship began in 1955 with the visit of Indian Prime Minister Nehru to Union of Soviet Socialist Republic (USSR) and the reciprocal visit of Premier Khrushchev to India.
- 2** During his visit, Nikita Khrushchev announced that USSR supported Indian sovereignty over the disputed territory of the Kashmir region and over the Portuguese coastal enclaves such as Goa.
- 3** In 1957, USSR vetoed anti-Indian initiatives in Jammu & Kashmir at the UN Security Council.
- 4** In 1962, USSR declared neutrality during the Indo-China war.
- 5** But soon defence manufacturing sector was added as an element of the bilateral relations and USSR agreed to transfer technology to co-produce the Mi-G-21 Jet fighter in India.



COLD WAR PERIOD (1945-1989)

- 6 In 1971, USSR and India signed the Treaty of Peace, Friendship and Cooperation. It was a defining moment in India-Russia relations.
- 7 The treaty safeguarded India's "security, sovereignty and territorial integrity", and made China refrain from getting involved in the 1971 Indo-Pakistan war in favor of Pakistan.
- 8 Cordial relations between the two nations continued and India's Rajiv Gandhi and Russia's Gorbachev exchanged visits in 1985 and 1986.



POST-COLD WAR PERIOD (1989 ONWARDS)

- 1 The disintegration of Soviet Union shaped the dynamics of future relations between India and Russia.
- 2 Indo-Russian relations are vital for both countries amidst a changing regional and global security environment.
- 3 Prime Minister Modi referred to the Indo-Russia relation as a 'privileged and strategic partnership'.
- 4 They share the goal of creating a multipolar world order.
- 5 India values the political and diplomatic support it continues to get from Russia on vital issues.



CONTEMPORARY RELATIONSHIP

The present relationship can be discussed under the following heads-

- Political
- Strategic
- Security
- Multilateral
- Defence
- Counter-Terrorism
- Energy
- Economic
- Cyber-Security
- Space
- Education
- Culture
- People-to-People ties
- Environment



POLITICAL

- 1 On 30 May 2017, both countries celebrated 70th anniversary of establishment of relations between India and Russia.
- 2 Both countries signed a 'Declaration on the India-Russia Partnership' in October 2000.
- 3 Both sides encourage intensive cooperation between their parliaments and noted the importance of antiparliamentary interaction as a valuable component of their bilateral relations.
- 4 They Chairman of the State Duma visited India in December 2018 and Speaker of the Lok Sabha visited Russia in 2019.
- 5 India-Russia try to collaborate on areas of democratization process, social policy, diffusion, secularism and multi-ethnicity.



STRATEGIC

- 1 Geopolitically, Russia continues to be an important balancing force against Pakistan and China.
- 2 In May 2018, Prime Minister Modi and President Putin met in Sochi to discuss the issues relating to develop the Russian-Indian privileged strategic partnership and matters of international and regional importance.
- 3 In 2018, the 19th Bilateral Summit between PM Modi and Russian President took place in Delhi and both sides agreed to cooperate on strategic, trade, civil nuclear and environmental matters.
- 4 Russians have backed India's position on Kashmir issue.



SECURITY

- 1 India and Russia signed an agreement on 'Information Security' aimed at countering terrorism, drug trafficking and other illegal cross-border activities.
- 2 Counter terrorism is an area of convergence between India and Russia.
- 3 They call the need for an effective global effort in dealing with the menace of terrorism.
- 4 They call for the elimination of all terrorist 'safe havens.'



SECURITY

- 5 They also share concerns about aggravation of security situation in Afghanistan.
- 6 India and Russian interests also converge on the Syrian issue.
- 7 Russia, however, did not back India's demand to name Pakistan-based terror groups as perpetrators of terror against India last year at the Goa's BRICS Summit when they issued the joint statement "Partnership for Global Peace and Stability"



MULTILATERAL COOPERATION

UNITED NATIONS

- 1 Both sides called for reform of the UNSC to reflect contemporary global realities and to make it more representative, effective and efficient in dealing with issues of international peace and security.
- 2 Russia has expressed support to India's candidacy for the permanent membership of a reformed UN Security Council

OTHERS

- 1 Russia also supported India's joining of the Nuclear Suppliers Group (NSG) and APEC.
- 2 The Sides support increased role of the SCO in international affairs and intensify cooperation within the BRICS and RIC framework.



MULTILATERAL COOPERATION

- 3 Both emphasize upon the implementation of the International North South Transport Corridor (INSTC).
- 4 They agree to improve coordination within the G20 and other international organizations to facilitate the resolution of important global issues.
- 5 Both sides support fair and open global economy and feel the need to strengthen the role of the World Trade Organization for upholding a transparent, non-discriminatory multilateral trading system.



MULTILATERAL COOPERATION

6 They are commitment to an equal security architecture in Asia and the Pacific region based on multilateralism, openness and inclusiveness .

7 They support efforts for an inclusive peace and Afghan-led and Afghan-owned reconciliation in Afghanistan.

8 They emphasize the importance of combating terrorist organizations in Syria

9 Both sides recognise the importance of full and effective implementation of the Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action or the Iranian Nuclear Programme (JCPOA) for securing regional and international peace, security and stability.



DEFENCE

- 1 In 1997, Russia and India signed a ten-year agreement for further military-technical cooperation.
- 2 Its agreement encompassed a wide range of activities, including the purchase of completed weaponry, joint development and production, and joint marketing of armaments and military technologies.
- 3 The seventh session of the Inter-Governmental commission on military-technical cooperation was held in October 2007 in Moscow.

- 4 During the visit, an agreement on joint development and production of prospective multi-role fighters was signed between the two countries.



DEFENCE

- 5** The India–Russia cooperation agreement has resulted in the sale of a multitude of defence equipment to India and the emergence of the countries as development partners as opposed to purely a buyer-seller relationship, for example the Fifth Generation Fighter Aircraft (FGFA) and the Multirole Transport Aircraft (MTA).
- 6** India and Russia have several major joint military programs including:
- BrahMos cruise missile program
 - 5th generation fighter jet program
 - Sukhoi Su-30MKI program (230+ to be built by Hindustan Aeronautics)
 - Ilyushin/HAL Tactical Transport Aircraft
 - Both countries signed a defence deal worth \$2.9 billion during President Putin's visit to India in December 2012



DEFENCE

S-400 TRIUMPH MISSILES

- 1 Indian government announced the purchase of five S-400 supersonic air defence system costing around \$60 billion in October 2018.
- 2 The S-400 is regarded as one the most advanced air defence missile systems in the world, capable of firing three different types of missiles at a short-to-extremely-long range.
- 3 The missiles can tackle a variety of targets, including aircraft jammers, reconnaissance aircraft, cruise missiles and short-range ballistic missiles.
- 4 The S-400 Triumph missiles are extremely efficient to track and hunt down combat aircraft, even stealth planes, at unprecedented ranges.
- 5 The purchase has unnerved Pakistan, India's long-time regional rival and a US ally, which voiced concerns that it could threaten strategic stability in the region.



MILITARY EXERCISES

1 The military cooperation between India and Russia is not mere of a buyer and a seller but includes joint research and development, training, service to service contacts, including joint exercises.

2 India and Russia concluded its first ever Tri-Services exercises in 2017 and continued joint military exercises-INDRA Navy, INDRSA Army and Avia INDRA.

3 They hold annual ministerial level defence reviews.

4 Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) and Rostec State Corporation signed a pact worth \$1billion to set up a joint venture that will make at least Russia Kamov-226T Utility helicopter in India.



COUNTER-TERRORISM

- 1 The leaders condemn terrorism in all its forms and manifestations and called on the international community to set up a united front to fight against it
- 2 India and Russia focus on increasing the effectiveness of countering terrorism, extremism, drug trafficking, cross-border organized crime, and information security threats, in particular by improving the functionality of the SCO Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure.
- 3 In 2019, at 11th meeting of the India-Russia Joint Working Group on Counter Terrorism India and Russia did not name Pakistan but called for elimination, of all 'safe havens' of terrorists in South Asia.
- 4 To address the threat of chemical and biological terrorism, both sides emphasize the need to launch multilateral negotiations on an international convention for the suppression of acts of chemical and biological terrorism at the Conference on Disarmament.



ENERGY COOPERATION

Energy is the most important pillar of cooperation between India and Russia.

- 1 India is energy deficient and Russia is energy surplus.
- 2 India and Russia boost up their Economic Partnership through CEPA.
- 3 Russia played a major role in building hydropower station developing India's coal industry.
- 4 Long-term LNG supply contract was signed between Gazprom Group and GAIL India Ltd.
- 5 OVL of ONGC invested 20% in Russia's \$12 billion Sakhalin Project.
- 6 India is also using US and Russia crude imports to bargain with its West Asian suppliers.
- 7 Steps should be taken to create a sustainable structure to take Russia-India energy partnership into the Eurasian region.



ENERGY COOPERATION

- 8 The countries cooperate in geological exploration and joint development of oil and gas fields in Russia and India, including offshore fields.
- 9 They work to develop the ways of delivering energy resources from Russia to India, including a long-term agreement for sourcing Russian crude oil, the possible use of the Northern Sea Route and a pipeline system.
- 10 There are prospects that Nayara Energy Limited could increase the capacity in Vadinar oil refinery.
- 11 India and Russia agreed to consider the prospects for expanding cooperation in hydro and thermal power, energy efficiency as well as for designing and constructing facilities that generate energy from non-conventional sources



CIVIL NUCLEAR ENERGY

1 Russia is an important partner in peaceful uses of nuclear energy and it recognised India as a country with advanced nuclear technology.

2 Indo-Russian Nuclear Cooperation includes-

1. Transfer of Nuclear Power Reactors
2. Fuel supply agreement for both supplied reactors and other reactors
3. Right to process spent fuel
4. Fuel supply assurance
5. Agreement to transfer reprocessing technology and enriched technology

3 In December 2014, the Department of Atomic Energy (DAE) and Russia's Rostam signed Strategic Vision for strengthening cooperation in peaceful uses of atomic energy.

4 Russia planned to involve India in building Russian designed nuclear power stations.



CIVIL NUCLEAR ENERGY

- 5 They pledged to cooperate in joint extraction of natural aluminum and production of nuclear fuel and atomic waste elimination.
- 6 Kundakulam Nuclear Power Plant (KKNPP) is being built in India with Russian cooperation. It is the first ever nuclear power plant to generate 1000 MW electric unit.
- 7 There were protests from locals fearing radiation threats and issues related to nuclear waste disposal. The sale of 98% stake in Essar Oil to a consortium led by Russian state-owned oil.
- 8 The construction of the remaining four of the six nuclear power plants at Kudankulam is in process
- 9 The countries cooperate in the construction of the Rooppur NPP in Bangladesh and expressed their readiness to expand similar cooperation in third countries.



CIVIL NUCLEAR ENERGY

10 There is immense potential of cooperation in the field of non-nuclear fuel and energy. Some of the successful ventures are

- JSC Rosneft Oil Company and Consortium of Oil and Gas Public Sector Undertakings in implementing the Vankorneft and Taas-Yuryakh Neftegazodobycha projects,
- Work of the Nayara Energy Limited oil refinery,
- Cooperation in extracting hydrocarbon resources
- Timely delivery of liquefied natural gas under the agreement between Gazprom and GAIL India.
- The countries agreed to cooperate in supply of coking coal from Russian Far East to India.



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